



WATCH OUT Montblanc has also introduced new watches for women in its Boheme collection with 30 mm and 34 mm dials

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nature “dancing diamonds” moving freely across the dial. The new releases from Chopard at Watches and Wonders also included elaborately embellished jewellery watches, feminine dress watches and minimalist gender-neutral watches.

In fact, gender-neutral watches are trending, as watch brands are introducing watches in the 38-39 mm sweet spot that works for both men and women. “Men remain at 75-80% of our customers, but we now see a growing number of ladies wearing big watches. The 38 mm dial in different colours and with coloured straps is a growing point of interest,” Jean-Marc Pontroué, CEO of Panerai, tells **BT**.

Undoubtedly, the number of women watch buyers remains small. At Ethos Limited, India’s largest retailer of luxury watches with 68 boutiques across the country, nearly 70% of sales comes from men’s watches. “But we will now be focussing on women’s watches to grow the popularity of horology for

ladies in India,” says Pranav Saboo, Managing Director and CEO of Ethos Limited.

Watch connoisseur Khatri says that while globally the market has been growing, India still has a long way to go. “We still don’t meet enough women who walk into a retail outlet and say that they want a particular watch because it has a tourbillon, or an annual calendar, etc.” However, she says that even if women haven’t reached the stage of selecting a technical watch, they are extremely conscious of the brand they wear. “The watch is a status symbol. It has become a conversation starter,” she says, adding that in her club of around a 100 members, women are buying brands like Roger Dubuis, Baume & Mercier, Panerai, etc.

Singh sums it up best when she says that for a lot of women, watches are like bags; you can’t have just one. **BT**

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